Four-Scene Short Story Video

Turn one small idea into a complete short video: Beginning, Problem, Action, Happy Ending - four scenes, four prompts, one story that actually finishes.



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Free student notes - Pictures & Video set

What this note is: a single shortcut, on its own, so you can save it, print it and use it in seconds. Plan the story with ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or Muse, then make each scene in Google Flow or any AI video tool.

Step 1 - Plan the story with one master prompt

Paste this into any AI chat first. It gives you a finished plan before you spend any time - or any video credits - on generating clips.

Master Story Planner

Works in: ChatGPT - Claude - Gemini - Muse

> Turn my idea into a short video story in exactly 4 scenes.
> My idea: [YOUR IDEA IN ONE LINE]
> Main character: [WHO - age, clothes, one clear feature]
> Rules:
> 1. Scene 1 - Beginning: show the character and the normal, happy start.
> 2. Scene 2 - Problem: one clear problem appears. Keep it simple.
> 3. Scene 3 - Action: the character tries hard to solve the problem.
> 4. Scene 4 - Happy Ending: the problem is solved and the feeling is warm.
> For EACH scene give me: (a) one line of story, (b) a ready-to-paste video prompt with the place, the action, the camera movement and the light, (c) one line the narrator can say.
> Keep my main character described in exactly the same words in all 4 video prompts. Use simple English. Total video length: about 30 to 40 seconds.

Fill the brackets: idea example - "a boy finds a lost puppy and takes it home". Character example - "a 10-year-old boy, short black hair, blue hoodie, orange backpack".

Step 2 - The four scene prompts for the video tool

If you already know your story, skip the planner and paste these four templates straight into Google Flow, one at a time. Only the middle changes - the character line and style line stay identical every time.

Scene 1 - Beginning

> [CHARACTER LINE]. [STYLE LINE]. Wide shot of [PLACE] at [TIME / LIGHT]. The character [HAPPY, NORMAL ACTION]. Slow camera push-in. Cheerful mood.

Scene 2 - Problem

> [CHARACTER LINE]. [STYLE LINE]. Medium shot in the same [PLACE]. Suddenly [THE PROBLEM HAPPENS]. The character looks worried. Camera stays still, then slowly zooms in on the face.

Scene 3 - Action

> [CHARACTER LINE]. [STYLE LINE]. The character [TRIES HARD - the solving action] in [PLACE]. Moving camera following the character. Determined mood, faster movement.

Scene 4 - Happy Ending

> [CHARACTER LINE]. [STYLE LINE]. Wide shot of [PLACE] in warm golden light. [THE PROBLEM IS SOLVED] and the character smiles. Slow camera pull-back. Warm, happy ending.

One action per scene: a video clip can only do one clear action well. If a scene has two actions, split it - do the more important one.

The two lines you never change

1. The character lock line

Describe the character once, in full detail, and paste the *exact same words* at the start of all four scene prompts. This is the single biggest secret to keeping the same character.

> **Example character line:** "A 10-year-old boy with short black hair, wearing a blue hoodie, dark shorts and an orange backpack, with a small light-brown puppy with floppy ears."

2. The style line

Pick one style and repeat it in every scene, so all four clips look like one film.

Style line to copy	Best for
Bright 3D cartoon style, soft light, smooth motion	Stories for children, school projects, fun stories
Warm realistic video, natural light, gentle camera movement	Moral stories, village and family stories
Soft watercolour storybook style, slow gentle motion	Poems, calm and emotional stories

> **The formula:** Beginning (who and where) + Problem (what goes wrong) + Action (what the character does) + Happy Ending (how it is solved). If a scene does not do its one job, rewrite that scene - do not add a fifth.

Making it in Google Flow - step by step

1. **Plan first.** Run the master prompt on page 2 in any AI chat. Read the 4 scenes. Fix the story now, while it is still only words.
2. **Set the shape.** In Google Flow, choose landscape (16:9) for YouTube and classroom screens, or portrait (9:16) for mobile status and reels. Use the same shape for all four scenes.
3. **Generate Scene 1 only.** Paste the Scene 1 prompt. Check the character's face, clothes and colours carefully - this clip sets the look for the whole video.
4. **Keep the winner.** If the character looks right, save that clip. If not, generate again before moving on. Never build the next scenes on a wrong first character.
5. **Scenes 2, 3 and 4, one by one.** Paste each prompt with the same character line and style line. Check each clip as it finishes: same character? Right action? No strange hands or extra people?
6. **Join the clips in order.** Put 1-2-3-4 together in Flow's scene builder or any free video editor on your phone.
7. **Add voice and sound.** Read the four narrator lines yourself, or use an AI voice. Add soft background music at low volume, under the voice.
8. **Add captions.** Put each narrator line as text on its scene. Many viewers watch with the sound off.
9. **Watch the full video once, start to finish,** before sharing. Check the story makes sense to someone who never read your plan.

Worked example - The Lost Puppy

Scene	Story line	Narrator line
1. Beginning	Ali walks to school through the village street at sunrise and sees a small puppy sitting alone.	"On his way to school, Ali found a little puppy, all alone."
2. Problem	Dark clouds gather, rain starts, and the puppy is cold, wet and frightened.	"Then the rain came, and the poor puppy was cold and scared."
3. Action	Ali wraps the puppy in his scarf, carries it carefully and asks at each door whose puppy it is.	"Ali kept it warm and asked at every door: whose puppy is this?"
4. Happy Ending	At the last house, a girl runs out smiling - it is her puppy. Ali waves goodbye in the golden evening light.	"At last, the puppy was home - and Ali had made two new friends."

Character line used in all four prompts: the boy-and-puppy line in the example box on page 3. Style line: "Bright 3D cartoon style, soft light, smooth motion."

Five story ideas that fit this formula

Idea	Problem (Scene 2)	Action and ending
The Honest Shopkeeper	A customer leaves extra money	He runs after her to return it; she thanks him and tells the whole village
The Little Tree	No rain for many days	A girl carries water every morning; the tree blooms again in spring
The Lost Kite	The kite sticks in a tall tree	Friends work together with a ladder and ideas; the kite flies again at sunset
The Injured Bird	A small bird cannot fly	Two friends feed and protect it for a week; it flies away over the fields
The New Student	A new boy sits alone, shy	A classmate shares lunch and introduces him; soon they play together

When a scene goes wrong - quick fixes

Problem you see	Fix to add or change
The character changes face or clothes	Paste the character line again, word for word, and add: "same character as before, same clothes, same colours"
Too many things happen at once	Cut to one action. Change the prompt to a single sentence about that action only
Strange hands, faces or extra people	Add: "simple scene, only the main character, clean background, no extra people"
The four clips look like different films	Use one style line in every prompt and the same time of day or light, except where the story changes it
Words or writing appear garbled on screen	Add: "no text, no words, no signs" - add your real words later as captions in the editor

Use it honestly. This shortcut is for stories you invent, class projects and learning. Do not copy another creator's story, characters or scenes and present the video as your own idea.

Check before you share. Watch every clip fully - if a clip looks wrong or confusing, regenerate that one scene instead of publishing it.

More shortcuts in this set: Image to Video - Same Character Every Time - Camera Moves Add-Ons - Google Flow Lesson Video - and many more free notes on the website.